

PERVEZ SHAIK MOHAMMED

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Recommender Systems | User Modeling | Domain Adaptation | Interpretability | Recursive Networks

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Sony Research Bangalore, India

User Engagement Research

Research Consultant

Mar 2026 – Present

- Researching non-LLM architectures for large-scale foundational recommendation systems and user personalization models.
- Developing domain alignment methods and unified semantic codebooks to learn generalized, discrete representations across different product domains.
- Researching user simulation methods to model how users respond to recommendations, using simulated feedback loops to iteratively improve engagement.

Research Intern

Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Developed the **PULSE framework**, which uses a small language model to generate reasoning traces about user behavior and feeds those traces back as training signal for the recommender; so the model learns from *why* a user might want something, not just *what* they clicked.
- Developed **RecRec**, a lightweight recursive recommendation model that refines user preference representations iteratively through a weight-shared module with an evidence-anchored correction mechanism, achieving competitive performance with only 3.9M–14M parameters.

Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur

On Campus

Summer Research Intern / Mentor: Dr. Tushar Sandhan

May – Jul 2024

- Designed a generative music system conditioned on real-time facial emotion recognition (ResNet-18, 85% accuracy) using a modified MuseGAN architecture for multi-track symbolic music synthesis.

International Institute of Information Technology Hyderabad

On Campus

Summer Research Intern / Mentor: Dr. Raman Saxena

May – Jul 2023

- Designed a financial distress prediction pipeline using ensemble learning; trained hybrid Random Forest and SVM models achieving 77% accuracy after normalization, with statistical feature selection on key financial indicators.

PUBLICATIONS

► From What to Why: Thought-Space Recommendation with Small Language Models.

P. Biswas, **Shaik, P.**, A. Thorat, R. Kolla, N. Pedanekar.
European Conference on Information Retrieval 2026 [CORE A]
[DOI](#) | [arXiv](#)

► RecRec: Recursive Refinement for Sequential Recommendation.

Shaik, P., P. Biswas, A. Thorat, R. Kolla, N. Pedanekar.
Under review

EDUCATION

JNTUH University College of Engineering Hyderabad

2020 – 2025

Dual Degree (B.Tech + M.Tech), Electronics & Communication Engineering

M.Tech GPA: 8.1/10

- Coursework:** Linear Algebra, Adaptive Signal Processing, Machine Learning, Pattern Recognition, Information Theory, Neural Networks.

GRANTS

- ECIR 2026 Student Support Grant (2026):** Awarded a competitive full conference registration waiver for ECIR 2026 in Delft, Netherlands.

VOLUNTEERING

- Served as Student Volunteer at **ECIR 2026** in Delft, Netherlands
- Served as Student Volunteer at **ICIET 2022** in JNTU Hyderabad

REFERENCES

- Prosenjit Biswas** – Research Scientist, Sony Research India | prosenjit.biswas@sony.com
- Dr. Tushar Sandhan** – Associate Professor, Dept. of EE, IIT Kanpur | sandhan@iitk.ac.in
- Dr. K. Anitha Sheela** – Professor, JNTUH UCEH | kanithasheela@jntuh.ac.in